

Faeonix is far too young, far too reckless, and entirely too convinced the world belongs to her.

Born into one of the oldest and wealthiest fox clans beneath the heavens, she was raised like a treasured jewel. Every luxury was placed at her feet. Every danger was kept far from her reach. Every step she took was watched by servants, elders, and guards who insisted it was for her own good.

To everyone else, she was a precious young mistress.

To Faeonix, she was a prisoner.

A spoiled princess locked inside a gilded cage was never enough.

She did not wish to become someone's obedient wife. She did not wish to inherit comfort. She did not even wish to become queen.

She would become **Empress**.

If no one intended to give her the title, she would simply take it herself.

So, with all the confidence of someone who had absolutely no idea how impossible her goal truly was, Faeonix declared herself the future Empress of the realm, slipped away from home, and disappeared into the endless chaos of the jianghu.

Naturally, her family sent her dragon guardian after her.

Officially, he exists to protect the young mistress.

Unofficially, his true duty is making sure she doesn't accidentally start a war before she reaches adulthood.

Her family expected her to return after a few difficult days.

Instead, she treated the jianghu like her personal playground.

She wandered from sect to sect, collected treasures that didn't belong to her, challenged people far stronger than herself, and somehow managed to leave behind equal measures of gratitude and headaches wherever she went.

Some villages remember the mysterious fox spirit who saved them from demons.

Others remember the little menace who stole an elder's prized wine, painted whiskers on a magistrate while he slept, and somehow escaped before anyone realized what had happened.

Whether she is a hero or a disaster often depends on who is telling the story.

Like every member of her influential fox clan, Faeonix rarely reveals her true identity. Hidden among humans, she prefers to travel beneath an endless collection of disguises, letting rumors grow larger than the truth.

Along the way, she acquired a reluctant companion named Faevyrn.

According to Faeonix, she graciously accepted him as her loyal retainer.

According to Faevyrn, he was never given a choice.

Regardless, the partnership somehow endures. She orders. He complains. She ignores every complaint and assumes complete obedience. Strangely enough, he continues following her anyway.

Her family also arranged a political marriage, believing it would strengthen their influence.

Faeonix rejected the idea immediately.

She refused to marry a stranger simply because powerful people demanded it.

If she were ever to marry, it would be to the most breathtakingly beautiful man beneath the heavens.

And should fate prove uncooperative...

Well.

Stealing him remained a perfectly acceptable alternative.

Despite her arrogance, selfishness, and endless appetite for mischief, Faeonix possesses a heart far kinder than she would ever admit. She cannot ignore injustice for long, often throwing herself into danger to help complete strangers before pretending it was never her intention.

She claims every good deed is merely part of her glorious rise to becoming Empress.

No one believes her.

During her travels, she encountered the eccentric cultivator Gnsyliuba.

After carefully observing her—and deciding she was entertaining enough to keep—Faeonix boldly declared her worthy of becoming *her* master.

Much to everyone's surprise, the arrangement lasted.

Behind her bizarre methods and impossible lessons, Gnsyliuba became one of the few people capable of tempering her reckless spirit without extinguishing it.

Even now, she cannot decide whether she is a hopeless old fool... or the greatest shifu in the world.

Perhaps both.

As for her family, they almost certainly know where she is.

Foxes as powerful as hers do not lose track of their youngest daughter so easily.

Still, they allow the illusion.

And Faeonix clings to that illusion with all her heart.

Because no matter how dangerous the jianghu becomes, no matter how many enemies she makes or impossible dreams she chases...

Anything is better than returning to the cage she escaped.